



Richard's NFL Playoff Pool

Official Rulebook

Pool #1: Pick the Score | Pool #2: Pick the Lines | Perfect Score Bonus

This rulebook covers all aspects of the pool and applies to every season. All rules are generic and season-independent unless otherwise noted. Specific dates, entry fees, and matchups are announced before each season begins.

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1. Pool Overview

Welcome to Richard's NFL Playoff Pool! This pool covers all four rounds of the NFL playoffs — Wild Card, Divisional, Conference Championships, and the Super Bowl. Every paid player competes in two separate pools simultaneously, and a Perfect Score Bonus gives players an additional way to win money on every single game.

1.1 The Two Pools

Pool #1: Pick the Score — Predict the exact final score of every game, both teams. Your score predictions also automatically calculate your Pool #2 picks, though you can edit Pool #2 independently.

Pool #2: Pick the Lines — Predict the Winner, Against the Spread (ATS), and Over/Under (O/U) result for every game, using the betting lines set by the Pool Manager. Pool #2 picks are hidden from other players until the Friday deadline passes.

Perfect Score Bonus — A separate bonus prize for any player who predicts the exact final score (both teams correct to the exact point) for any game in Pool #1 only. A player can win this multiple times in a single week or across the entire season.

1.2 Pool Structure

- The entry fee for the current season is set before the season opens and is displayed in the app header — check the app or your registration email for the current fee
- One entry fee covers all 4 weeks of the playoffs — both Pool #1 and Pool #2
- All paid players automatically participate in both Pool #1 and Pool #2
- 15 prizes total: 10 Pool #1 prizes + 5 Pool #2 prizes
- Each prize is worth an equal share of the prize pool (see Section 8 for the Perfect Score reserve deduction)
- Players can enter up to the maximum capacity set by the Pool Manager

Prize Summary:

- Pool #1 Prizes: #1 through #10 (2 per week for Weeks 1–3, 4 in Week 4)
- Pool #2 Prizes: #11 through #15 (1 per week for all 4 weeks, plus 1 Grand Prize)
- Perfect Score Bonus: Separate pot funded from entry fees — see Section 8

2. Entry Requirements & Payment

2.1 Entry Fee

The entry fee for each season is announced by the Pool Manager before the season opens. It is displayed prominently in the app header and communicated by email to all registered players before registration opens.

Payment Details:

- E-transfer to: gammoneer2b@gmail.com
- E-transfer password: nflpool
- Include your name in the payment message
- Payment must be confirmed by the Pool Manager before your access code is activated

2.2 Access Codes

Each player receives a unique 6-character alphanumeric access code upon payment confirmation.

- One code per player — valid for all 4 weeks of that season
- Your name is pre-loaded by the Pool Manager — enter your code on the app to access your picks
- DO NOT share your access code — you are responsible for all picks submitted under your code
- Lost codes: contact the Pool Manager to have your code re-sent

2.3 Late Entry

Late entries may be accepted at the Pool Manager's discretion, subject to all of the following:

- The pool has not reached maximum capacity
- Payment is received and confirmed at least 1 hour before the Week 1 deadline
- The player enters picks immediately after payment confirmation

Late entries who fail to submit picks before the deadline will have RNG picks applied automatically — see Section 9.

3. Pick Submission Schedule & Deadlines

3.1 The One Rule That Governs All Deadlines

All picks for each week lock at Friday 11:59 PM PST before that playoff weekend's games.

This applies to both Pool #1 and Pool #2. No exceptions.

3.2 Weekly Schedule

Specific dates for each season are announced before the season begins and are visible in the app. The pattern is always the same:

- Week 1 (Wild Card Round): The pool opens Monday 12:01 AM PST — the Monday immediately after the final regular season Sunday games are completed. Pick window is approximately 5 days (Monday through Friday). Deadline is Friday 11:59 PM PST before Wild Card games begin on Saturday.
- Week 2 (Divisional Round): Opens Tuesday 12:01 AM PST — Wild Card weekend includes a Monday night game, so Week 2 cannot open until Tuesday. Approximately 4 days to pick (Tuesday through Friday).
- Week 3 (Conference Championships): Opens Monday 12:01 AM PST — Divisional games finish Sunday night, so Week 3 opens Monday morning. Approximately 5 days to pick (Monday through Friday).
- Week 4 (Super Bowl): Opens Monday 12:01 AM PST — Conference Championship games finish Sunday night, so Week 4 opens Monday morning. Approximately 11 days to pick (Monday through the Friday before Super Bowl weekend).

3.3 Editing Picks

- Picks can be edited unlimited times from when they are first entered until Friday 11:59 PM PST
- After the Friday deadline, picks are permanently locked automatically by the app
- If a player has no picks saved at all when the deadline passes, the app automatically generates RNG picks for that player — see Section 9
- No changes are possible once locked — picks stand exactly as entered

Best Practice: Enter your picks as early as possible in each week's pick window and refine them as needed before the Friday deadline. Every week has a defined window — use it.

3.4 The 24-Hour Support Rule

The Pool Manager cannot guarantee monitoring or support in the final 24 hours before any deadline. If you have a technical issue:

- Report it MORE than 24 hours before the deadline — Pool Manager may be able to assist
- Report it LESS than 24 hours before the deadline — you are on your own

The responsibility to enter picks on time rests entirely with each player.

4. Pool #1: Pick the Score — How to Play

4.1 What You Are Predicting

For every game in the current week, you predict the final score of both teams in Pool #1. The team you give the higher score is your predicted winner.

Example: You enter KC 28 — LV 17. You are predicting KC wins 28–17. KC is your winner pick.

4.2 All-or-Nothing Submission

Every score field for every game in that week must be filled in before your picks can be submitted. You cannot submit partial picks.

- Enter a number in every field — even rough estimates count as valid picks
- If any field is empty the submission is rejected — fill in all fields first
- Once submitted, picks stand as entered — unusual or extreme numbers are valid

4.3 How Pool #2 Picks Are Calculated From Pool #1

When you save your Pool #1 score picks, the app automatically calculates your Pool #2 picks (Winner, ATS, and O/U) from your Pool #1 entered scores using the current betting lines and saves them to Pool #2 at the same time. You can edit your Pool #2 Winner, ATS, and O/U picks independently in Pool #2 at any time before the Friday deadline.

If the Pool Manager has not yet entered the betting lines when you submit your Pool #1 picks, your Pool #2 picks will be empty temporarily. As soon as the Pool Manager enters the lines, the app will automatically calculate and save Pool #2 picks for all players who have Pool #1 picks but no Pool #2 picks yet. You do not need to do anything — your Pool #2 will be filled in automatically. You can then review and edit your Pool #2 picks at any time before the Friday deadline.

Pool #2 betting lines (favourite, spread, and O/U) are entered by the Pool Manager as early as possible at the start of each week.

Pool #2 Timestamp Rule:

Your Pool #2 submission timestamp is set to match your Pool #1 submission timestamp — not the time the lines were entered by the Pool Manager. This means submitting your Pool #1 picks early automatically gives you an early Pool #2 timestamp as well, which is important because the timestamp is the final tiebreaker for all Pool #2 prizes.

If you manually edit any of your Pool #2 picks afterward, your Pool #2 timestamp updates to the time of that manual edit.

Tiebreaker tip: Submit your Pool #1 picks early in the week. This locks in an early timestamp for Pool #2 automatically — even if you never manually edit your Pool #2 picks.

4.4 Scoring in Pool #1

Pool #1 does not award points per game — it determines prize winners based on two criteria:

- Most Correct Winners — how many game winners you predicted correctly across all games in that week
- Closest Total Points — how close your predicted total (sum of all score predictions in the week) is to the actual combined total for that week

These two criteria each award one prize per week. See Section 6 for full prize details.

5. Pool #2: Pick the Lines — How to Play

Pool #2 is a separate pool based on betting lines — the same type of lines used by professional sports books. All three picks described below are made within Pool #2 only and are completely separate from your Pool #1 score predictions, even though Pool #1 predictions are used to auto-calculate your starting Pool #2 picks.

You can also refer to the "How do the Lines Work?" section within the Pool #2 tab in the app for an interactive explanation using real game examples.

5.1 The Three Picks Per Game — Pool #2 Only

For each game in Pool #2, you make three separate picks. Each pick is scored independently:

Pick 1: Winner (2 points) — Pool #2 only

Pick which team wins the game outright. When you submit your Pool #1 score predictions, the app automatically sets your Winner pick in Pool #2 to whichever team you predicted to score more points in Pool #1. You can change this independently in Pool #2 if you wish.

Pick 2: Against the Spread — ATS (3 points) — Pool #2 only

This pick requires a little explanation if you have never encountered it before, but it is straightforward once understood.

The spread is a points handicap assigned to the favourite team by the betting line. It levels the playing field by requiring the favourite to win by more than a set margin for the pick to be correct.

How to read the spread:

- A team listed as the FAVOURITE has a MINUS (–) number — for example –10. They must win by MORE than 10 points for a pick on them to be correct.
- A team listed as the UNDERDOG has a PLUS (+) number — for example +10. They cover the spread if they win outright OR if they lose by fewer than 10 points.
- The spread almost always ends in .5 — for example –7.5 or +4.5. This is deliberate. The .5 ensures the margin can never land exactly on the spread number, so there is never a push or tie on the ATS pick. You are always either right or wrong.

ATS Example: LAC –7.5 at HOU +7.5

LAC is the favourite. They must win by 8 or more points for a LAC ATS pick to be correct.
HOU is the underdog. They cover if they win outright OR if they lose by 7 points or fewer.

Your Pool #1 prediction: LAC 45 — HOU 33. Your Pool #1 score auto-sets your ATS pick to LAC -7.5 since you predicted LAC to win by 12.

Actual result: LAC 34 — HOU 31. LAC won by only 3 points — less than 7.5.

LAC did NOT cover the spread.

- If your ATS pick was LAC -7.5 → ❌ Wrong (0 points)
- If your ATS pick was HOU +7.5 → ✅ Correct (3 points) — HOU only lost by 3, within their +7.5 cushion

Simple rule: The minus team must win big. The plus team just needs to stay close or win outright.

Pick 3: Over / Under — O/U (3 points) — Pool #2 only

The Over/Under line is a number representing the expected combined total points scored by both teams in the game. You pick whether the actual combined total will be Over or Under that number.

Like the spread, the O/U line almost always ends in .5 — for example 42.5 or 47.5. This is deliberate so that the combined score can never land exactly on the line, eliminating any push. You are always either Over or Under — never exactly on the number.

O/U Example: Line is 42.5

Actual result: LAC 34 + HOU 31 = 65 combined points.

65 is greater than 42.5 → the result is OVER.

- If your pick was Over → ✅ Correct (3 points)
- If your pick was Under → ❌ Wrong (0 points)

Simple rule: Add both teams' final scores together. Is the total bigger or smaller than the O/U line?

5.2 Points Per Game in Pool #2

For each game in Pool #2 you can earn a maximum of 8 points:

- Winner correct: 2 points
- ATS correct: 3 points
- O/U correct: 3 points
- Maximum per game: 8 points

Your weekly Pool #2 score is the total points earned across all games in that week:

- Wild Card (6 games): maximum 48 points
- Divisional (4 games): maximum 32 points
- Conference (2 games): maximum 16 points

- Super Bowl (1 game): maximum 8 points

5.3 Betting Lines — Where They Come From

The Pool Manager enters the favourite, spread, and O/U for each game as early as possible at the start of each week, based on the betting lines posted by sports books at that time. The entry timing is:

- Week 1 (Wild Card): Lines entered Monday as early as possible — the same day the pool opens
- Week 2 (Divisional): Lines entered Tuesday as early as possible — the first day Week 2 is open
- Week 3 (Conference): Lines entered Monday as early as possible — the first day Week 3 is open
- Week 4 (Super Bowl): Lines entered Monday as early as possible — the first day Week 4 is open

Once the lines are entered they are locked in for the entire week and do not change.

Players do not need to monitor the lines for any shifting — what is set at the start of the week is what counts through to the Friday deadline. This ensures fairness and stability for all players.

6. Pool #1 Prize Structure & Tiebreaker Rules (Prizes #1–#10)

6.1 Prize Distribution

- Prize #1 — Week 1 (Wild Card): Most Correct Winners
- Prize #2 — Week 1 (Wild Card): Closest Total Points
- Prize #3 — Week 2 (Divisional): Most Correct Winners
- Prize #4 — Week 2 (Divisional): Closest Total Points
- Prize #5 — Week 3 (Conference): Most Correct Winners
- Prize #6 — Week 3 (Conference): Closest Total Points
- Prize #7 — Week 4 (Super Bowl): Correct Super Bowl Winner
- Prize #8 — Week 4 (Super Bowl): Closest Super Bowl Total Points
- Prize #9 — Grand Prize: Most Correct Winners (all 4 weeks, all 13 games)
- Prize #10 — Grand Prize: Closest Total Points (all 4 weeks combined)

6.2 Critical Tiebreaker Philosophy

The goal of the tiebreaker system is to find one winner per prize.

The tiebreaker chain is designed so that a true unresolvable tie is extremely rare. Each step eliminates players until one remains. Only if every single tiebreaker step is fully exhausted and players remain exactly tied do they share the prize equally.

Closest always means absolute difference — being 5 points over or 5 points under the actual is the same result (5 points away). Direction does not matter, only distance.

The timestamp is the ultimate final tiebreaker. If all other steps are exhausted, the player who submitted their picks earliest wins. This means submitting early gives you a tiebreaker advantage.

6.3 How Tiebreakers Work — The Elimination Process

Every tiebreaker follows this elimination process:

1. Apply the next tiebreaker step to all remaining tied players
2. Find which player(s) have the best result at that step
3. Keep ONLY those players with the best result — drop everyone else
4. If only one player remains → that player wins
5. If multiple players remain → move to the next step and repeat
6. If all steps exhausted and still tied → share prize equally

Tiebreaker Example — Prize #5 (Week 3: Most Correct Winners)

Starting: Curtis, Dennis, and Kevin all correctly predicted 2 winners in Week 3. All are tied.

Step 1: Check Week 3 total points (closest to actual):

- Curtis: predicted 174, actual 157 → 17 points off
- Dennis: predicted 174, actual 157 → 17 points off
- Kevin: predicted 163, actual 157 → 19 points off

Kevin is eliminated (19 > 17). Remaining tied: Curtis and Dennis only.

Step 2: Look back to Week 2 total points:

- Curtis: predicted 196, actual 191 → 5 points off
- Dennis: predicted 193, actual 191 → 2 points off

Dennis wins — 2 points off beats 5 points off. Curtis eliminated.

6.4 Prize #1 — Week 1: Most Correct Winners

Winner: Player with the most correctly predicted winning NFL teams in Week 1.

Tiebreaker chain:

1. Compare tied players' Week 1 total points (closest to actual wins, others eliminated)
2. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
3. If still tied → share prize

6.5 Prize #2 — Week 1: Closest Total Points

Winner: Player whose predicted total points for Week 1 is closest to the actual combined total.

Tiebreaker chain:

1. Earliest submission timestamp wins
2. If still tied → share prize

6.6 Prize #3 — Week 2: Most Correct Winners

Winner: Player with the most correctly predicted winning NFL teams in Week 2.

Tiebreaker chain:

1. Compare tied players' Week 2 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
2. If still tied → look back to Week 1 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
3. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
4. If still tied → share prize

6.7 Prize #4 — Week 2: Closest Total Points

Winner: Player whose predicted Week 2 total is closest to actual.

Tiebreaker chain:

1. Look back to Week 1 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
2. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
3. If still tied → share prize

6.8 Prize #5 — Week 3: Most Correct Winners

Winner: Player with the most correctly predicted winning NFL teams in Week 3.

Tiebreaker chain:

1. Compare Week 3 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
2. If still tied → look back to Week 2 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
3. If still tied → look back to Week 1 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
4. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
5. If still tied → share prize

6.9 Prize #6 — Week 3: Closest Total Points

Winner: Player whose predicted Week 3 total is closest to actual.

Tiebreaker chain:

1. Look back to Week 2 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
2. If still tied → look back to Week 1 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
3. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
4. If still tied → share prize

6.10 Prize #7 — Super Bowl: Correct Winner Pick

Winner: Player(s) who correctly predicted the Super Bowl winning team.

If nobody picked correctly, all players are treated as tied and the full tiebreaker chain applies to everyone.

Tiebreaker chain (oldest to newest week — intentionally opposite to Prize #8 to reduce same-player winning both):

1. Compare Week 1 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
2. If still tied → compare Week 2 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
3. If still tied → compare Week 3 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
4. If still tied → compare Week 4 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
5. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
6. If still tied → share prize

6.11 Prize #8 — Super Bowl: Closest Total Points (Super Bowl game only)

Winner: Player whose predicted Super Bowl total is closest to the actual Super Bowl combined score.

Note: Week 4 is skipped as a tiebreaker because Week 4 IS the Super Bowl — using it would be redundant. The chain goes straight to Week 3 and works backward.

Tiebreaker chain (newest to oldest week — intentionally opposite to Prize #7):

1. Look back to Week 3 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
2. If still tied → look back to Week 2 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
3. If still tied → look back to Week 1 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
4. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
5. If still tied → share prize

6.12 Prize #9 — Grand Prize: Most Correct Winners (All 4 Weeks)

Winner: Player with the most correctly predicted game winners across all 13 games of the entire playoffs.

Tiebreaker chain:

1. Compare Grand Total points difference (combined 4-week predicted total vs actual — closest wins)
2. If still tied → compare Week 4 total points (closest wins)
3. If still tied → compare Week 3 total points (closest wins)
4. If still tied → compare Week 2 total points (closest wins)
5. If still tied → compare Week 1 total points (closest wins)
6. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
7. If still tied → share prize

6.13 Prize #10 — Grand Prize: Closest Total Points (All 4 Weeks)

Winner: Player whose combined 4-week predicted total is closest to the actual combined 4-week total.

Tiebreaker chain (work backward from most recent week):

1. Compare Week 4 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
2. If still tied → compare Week 3 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
3. If still tied → compare Week 2 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
4. If still tied → compare Week 1 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
5. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
6. If still tied → share prize

7. Pool #2 Prize Structure & Tiebreaker Rules (Prizes #11–#15)

7.1 Prize Distribution

- Prize #11 — Week 1 (Wild Card): Most Pool #2 Points
- Prize #12 — Week 2 (Divisional): Most Pool #2 Points
- Prize #13 — Week 3 (Conference): Most Pool #2 Points
- Prize #14 — Week 4 (Super Bowl): Most Pool #2 Points
- Prize #15 — Grand Prize: Most Pool #2 Points (all 4 weeks combined)

7.2 Tiebreaker Philosophy for Pool #2

Pool #2 tiebreakers are always exhausted first before any Pool #1 tiebreakers are applied.

The full tiebreaker order for all Pool #2 prizes is: Pool #2 points tiebreakers first → then Pool #1 total points tiebreakers → then submission timestamp → then share prize if all else equal.

The timestamp is always the last step before sharing — the player who submitted their picks earliest wins if everything else is tied.

7.3 Prize #11 — Week 1: Most Pool #2 Points

Winner: Player with the most Pool #2 points in Week 1 (maximum 48 points across 6 games).

Tiebreaker chain:

1. Compare Pool #1 Week 1 total points (closest to actual wins, others eliminated)
2. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
3. If still tied → share prize

7.4 Prize #12 — Week 2: Most Pool #2 Points

Winner: Player with the most Pool #2 points in Week 2 (maximum 32 points across 4 games).

Tiebreaker chain:

1. Compare Week 1 Pool #2 points (most wins, others eliminated)
2. If still tied → compare Pool #1 Week 2 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
3. If still tied → compare Pool #1 Week 1 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
4. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
5. If still tied → share prize

7.5 Prize #13 — Week 3: Most Pool #2 Points

Winner: Player with the most Pool #2 points in Week 3 (maximum 16 points across 2 games).

Tiebreaker chain:

1. Compare Week 2 Pool #2 points (most wins, others eliminated)
2. If still tied → compare Week 1 Pool #2 points (most wins, others eliminated)
3. If still tied → compare Pool #1 Week 3 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
4. If still tied → compare Pool #1 Week 2 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
5. If still tied → compare Pool #1 Week 1 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
6. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
7. If still tied → share prize

7.6 Prize #14 — Week 4: Most Pool #2 Points

Winner: Player with the most Pool #2 points in Week 4 / Super Bowl (maximum 8 points for 1 game).

Tiebreaker chain:

1. Compare Week 3 Pool #2 points (most wins, others eliminated)
2. If still tied → compare Week 2 Pool #2 points (most wins, others eliminated)
3. If still tied → compare Week 1 Pool #2 points (most wins, others eliminated)
4. If still tied → compare Pool #1 Week 4 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
5. If still tied → compare Pool #1 Week 3 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
6. If still tied → compare Pool #1 Week 2 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
7. If still tied → compare Pool #1 Week 1 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
8. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
9. If still tied → share prize

7.7 Prize #15 — Grand Prize: Most Pool #2 Points (All 4 Weeks)

Winner: Player with the most combined Pool #2 points across all 4 weeks.

Tiebreaker chain (work backward from most recent week):

1. Compare Week 4 Pool #2 points (most wins, others eliminated)
2. If still tied → compare Week 3 Pool #2 points (most wins, others eliminated)
3. If still tied → compare Week 2 Pool #2 points (most wins, others eliminated)
4. If still tied → compare Week 1 Pool #2 points (most wins, others eliminated)
5. If still tied → compare Pool #1 Grand Total points difference (closest wins, others eliminated)
6. If still tied → compare Pool #1 Week 4 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
7. If still tied → compare Pool #1 Week 3 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
8. If still tied → compare Pool #1 Week 2 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)

9. If still tied → compare Pool #1 Week 1 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
10. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
11. If still tied → share prize

8. Perfect Score Bonus

8.1 What Is the Perfect Score Bonus?

The Perfect Score Bonus rewards any player who predicts the exact final score of any game in Pool #1 only — meaning both teams' scores are correct to the exact point. This bonus applies to Pool #1 score predictions only. Pool #2 does not qualify.

The bonus is funded by a reserve set aside from the total entry fees collected from all players at the start of the season. It is completely separate from the 15 main prizes.

Every paid player is automatically eligible for the Perfect Score Bonus — no separate entry required. Being paid means you are in both Pool #1 and Pool #2, and the Perfect Score Bonus is available to all paid players through their Pool #1 picks.

8.2 How the Bonus Pot Is Funded

10% of the total entry fees collected from all players is set aside as the Perfect Score Bonus pot at the start of the season. The remaining 90% is divided equally among the 15 main prizes.

Funding Example: 30 players × \$30 entry fee = \$900 total entry fees

- Perfect Score Bonus pot: $\$900 \times 10\% = \90
- Main prize pool: $\$900 \times 90\% = \810
- Each of the 15 prizes: $\$810 \div 15 = \54 per prize

The exact prize amounts for the current season are displayed in the app under Prizes, Standings & Results.

8.3 How to Win the Perfect Score Bonus

A Perfect Score hit is recorded any time a player's Pool #1 prediction matches the actual final score exactly — both the away team score AND the home team score must be correct.

- A player can earn multiple Perfect Score hits in a single week — one per game
- A player can earn Perfect Score hits across multiple weeks throughout the season
- There is no limit to how many times a single player can win
- Each hit counts equally regardless of which week or which game it occurred in
- Games are numbered sequentially: Wild Card = Games 1–6, Divisional = Games 7–10, Conference = Games 11–12, Super Bowl = Game 13

8.4 How the Bonus Pot Is Paid Out

After the season is fully complete and all 13 games are final, the total number of Perfect Score hits across all players and all games is counted. The pot is then divided equally by the total number of hits.

Payout Example:

Perfect Score pot = \$90

Hits across all players all season:

- Richard — 2 perfect score hits (Wild Card Game 3, Divisional Game 8)
- Dave — 1 perfect score hit (Conference Game 11)
- Total hits = 3

Payout per hit = $\$90 \div 3 = \30 per hit

- Richard receives \$60 (2 hits $\times$ \$30)
- Dave receives \$30 (1 hit $\times$ \$30)

Both players also remain fully eligible for all 15 main prizes — Perfect Score winnings are in addition to prize winnings, never instead of.

8.5 If Nobody Scores a Perfect Score All Season

If no player hits a perfect score across any game in any week during the entire season, the Perfect Score pot does not go to waste.

The entire pot rolls back into the main prize pool and is divided equally among all 15 prizes.

Rollback Example:

Perfect Score pot = \$90, zero hits all season

$\$90 \div 15$ prizes = \$6 extra per prize

If each prize was \$54, it becomes \$60 for the season.

8.6 Perfect Score Visibility

All Perfect Score hits are visible to all players at all times in the Prizes, Standings & Results section of the app. Individual hits are recorded and displayed as games are finalized throughout the season.

The final Perfect Score bonus payout calculation and dollar amounts per hit are not calculated until after the entire season is fully completed and all 13 games are final.

The Pool Manager has the ability to correct any hit that was recorded incorrectly due to a data error.

9. Random Number Generator (RNG) Rule

9.1 Purpose

Every paid player must have picks entered for every week of the playoffs. No paid player can skip a week. The RNG rule ensures this automatically.

9.2 When RNG Is Applied

After the Friday 11:59 PM PST deadline, the app automatically generates RNG picks for any paid player who has zero picks saved for that week. This happens before the first game of that weekend kicks off.

- Applied only to players with no picks at all for that week — all fields completely empty
- Applied to both Pool #1 and Pool #2 simultaneously
- Generated scores range from 10 to 45 per team
- RNG picks count as the player's official entry for that week
- The Pool Manager verifies the app has applied RNG correctly after the deadline

9.3 When RNG Is NOT Applied

The following situations do NOT trigger RNG:

- Player entered any numbers at all — even rough estimates, even extreme numbers
- Player entered numbers but made a mistake — picks stand as entered
- Player wants to change picks after the deadline — too late
- Pool Manager thinks a player "meant something else" — no guessing, no substitutions

If you entered something — anything — it stands. RNG only applies when the submission is completely empty.

9.4 RNG Indicator

Players who received RNG picks will have a 🎲 (dice) indicator next to their name in the all-players picks table, the standings, and the prize breakdowns. This indicator is visible to all players so everyone can see which entries were system-generated.

Pick windows by week:

- Week 1 (Wild Card): 5 days — Monday through Friday
- Week 2 (Divisional): 4 days — Tuesday through Friday
- Week 3 (Conference): 5 days — Monday through Friday

- Week 4 (Super Bowl): 11 days — Monday through the Friday before Super Bowl weekend

Every week has a defined pick window. Enter your picks early in each window and the 🎲 indicator will never apply to you.

10. Pool Manager Authority & Responsibilities

10.1 Pool Manager Role

The Pool Manager administers this pool as a service to the community — this is done for fun and community, not for compensation. The Pool Manager operates with complete integrity and fairness at all times.

This pool has been built over 1000+ hours of development and is backed by 25+ years of running regular season pools and 45+ years of pool participation experience.

10.2 What the Pool Manager Will Do

- Enter betting lines (favourite, spread, and O/U) for Pool #2 as early as possible at the start of each week
- Verify that the app has automatically applied RNG picks to any paid player with zero picks after the Friday deadline
- Verify prize winners calculated by the app after each playoff weekend and confirm they are correct
- Review all pick tables, actual scores, and prize calculations displayed in the app for accuracy
- Correct any data errors (scores, Perfect Score hits, etc.) using the Pool Manager Override tools in the app
- Investigate and resolve technical issues reported more than 24 hours before a deadline
- Review access code issues and re-send lost codes
- Consider late entries at discretion (see Section 2.3)
- Send a post-weekend email confirming prize winners and Perfect Score hits after each playoff weekend
- Make final decisions on any disputes — fairly and transparently

Note: The 🎲 dice indicator next to a player's name in the app is the notification that RNG was applied to that player — it is visible to all players including the affected player. The Pool Manager does not send individual notifications.

10.3 What the Pool Manager Will NOT Do

- Unlock or extend a deadline — this is extremely unlikely to ever happen and players should treat it as never going to occur. Plan accordingly.
- Edit or change a player's valid picks for any reason — picks stand as entered
- Change picks because a player "made a mistake" — if you submitted it, it counts
- Contact players to ask "did you mean this?" — no intent-guessing ever
- Apply RNG before the deadline — picks must be genuinely missing, not just late
- Give special treatment to any player based on friendship or circumstance

Why such firm rules? Flexibility causes problems. One extension leads to requests for more. One exception becomes "why not me?" These rules have worked smoothly for 25+ years. Everyone enters early, edits freely, and enjoys the pool with zero stress.

10.4 Dispute Resolution

The Pool Manager has final authority on all disputes. Decisions are based on:

- App timestamps — the record of when picks were submitted is definitive
- Firebase data — the actual stored picks are the official record
- Fairness to all players — decisions apply equally to everyone

In extreme circumstances where pool integrity cannot be maintained, the Pool Manager reserves the right to refund all entry fees and cancel the pool.

10.5 Rule Adjustments Mid-Season

Rules may only be adjusted mid-season in rare cases where fairness requires it. Any adjustment must be:

- Documented and announced to all players immediately
- Applied equally to all players
- Made in the interest of fairness — never to benefit any specific player

11. Results & Transparency

11.1 What Players Can See At All Times

- Pool #1 picks — all players can view everyone's Pool #1 picks immediately after submission at any time
- Pool #2 picks — visible to all players only after the Friday 11:59 PM PST deadline passes for that week (see Section 11.2)
- Timestamps showing when each player last submitted their picks for each week
- Prize standings and current leaders, updated automatically as games are finalized
- Perfect Score hits recorded as games are finalized — final payout amounts are calculated only after the entire season is complete
- CSV download available from the all-players picks table for both Pool #1 and Pool #2

11.2 Pool #2 Blind Period

Pool #2 picks are hidden from all other players until the Friday 11:59 PM PST deadline passes for that week. After the deadline, all Pool #2 picks become visible to everyone.

This blind period is designed to prevent players from copying each other's betting line picks. Your Pool #1 picks are always visible immediately after submission.

11.3 Post-Weekend Communication

After each playoff weekend, the Pool Manager will send an email confirming:

- Prize winners for that week, with tiebreaker notes if applicable
- Perfect Score hits for that week

All actual scores, prize calculations, standings, and pick tables are displayed automatically in the app and are available to all players at any time.

12. Final Notes

This pool exists because of a shared love of football and friendly competition. The rules are designed to be fair, transparent, and final — so that everyone can focus on enjoying the playoffs rather than debating process.

The Golden Rule of This Pool: Enter your picks early. You can always edit them before the Friday deadline. Waiting until the last minute is a choice — and the consequences are your own.

Questions or technical issues? Contact Pool Manager Richard using the contact information provided with your access code.

Good luck to all players — let the games begin! 

Richard's NFL Playoff Pool — Official Rulebook — All rules are generic and applicable to every season